

Automatic starter

Q. I have a Pentium III 600 MHz computer with 128 MB RAM and a 17.2 GB hard disk. I have installed Windows 98 and Windows XP. Recently, I connected a Panasonic KX-FM 131 fax machine to the COM1 port. The device is working perfectly, but whenever I shut down the system, the computer displays the Shutdown screen and then reboots. Even if I simply turn on the main power switch, the computer starts on its own. When I removed the modem, it started working normally again. I tried switching the modem to COM2, but the problem persists. I also have a



Motorola SM56 PCI internal modem connected as COM4. Can you please help?

Rajesh
Bangalore

A This is indeed a weird problem. Boot the machine and enter the BIOS setup by pressing the [Delete] key. Check the BIOS to see if options such as Wake on (or Power on) Ring or Wake on (or Power on) LAN are enabled. If they are, disable them and see if the problem is solved. If not, check if the BIOS has other Power on options, such as by a particular key-combination. Disable all such options and check if the problem is solved.

Mass mailing

Q. I use Outlook Express 6 with all updates and patches applied. Whenever I send messages to many recipients, several of the messages bounce back with a note from the Webmaster stating 'Too Many Recipients. Delivery Failed'. However, if the list is small, the messages are dispatched promptly. My ISP is Dishnet, Chennai. Please help.

V. Ravchandran
Chennai

A This is not a problem with Outlook Express. This is a setting commonly used by ISPs to prevent spam—they assume that if an e-mail is sent to a number of people, it must be spam. Usually the limit is 20 recipients, beyond which messages will be bounced back with errors. You can work around the problem by sending mail to a lesser number of recipients. If you need to send mail to a large number of people regularly, use a mass mailing software such as Bulk Email Express Free (www.bulkemailexpress.com). Software such as these usually send out individual messages to a list of recipients, and can optionally personalise each message too.

CD writing speeds

Q. I have bought a new Sony CD-Writer. My computer's configuration is Pentium III 933 MHz processor, 256 MB RAM and a 20 GB hard disk. The CD-Writer takes around 10 to 12 minutes to write 650 MB of data at 32x write speed. Can you tell me how I can decrease the time taken? Does the speed depend on the software used? I use Nero Burning ROM 5.5. Should I change the software?

Sanjay
Via e-mail

A No matter what speed you set the Writer to write at, it will not write faster than the media's maximum speed, or the CD will not be written correctly. Commonly available CD-Rs max out at 16x, with some going up to 24x write speeds. Nero is a pretty good CD writing software and automatically detects the maximum speed of the disc, thus preventing damage to it. Unless you get faster CD-Rs, you will not be able to write at faster speeds.

Can't open Hotmail

Q. I have a problem with certain sites such as Hotmail and Indiatimes mail. When I enter the sign-in name and password, the same page reappears. This also

A The program that is trying to run (most probably LiteStep), is referencing a DLL file, mfc42.dll. This DLL is probably the wrong version. To correct the error, simply reinstall the program. If the problem still persists, try downloading the file from <http://www.webattack.com/help/missingfiles.html> and copy it to the folder where the program is installed. It is possible that the mfc42.dll file version on your computer is incompatible with this software, so you may have to try out a few versions to determine the correct one.

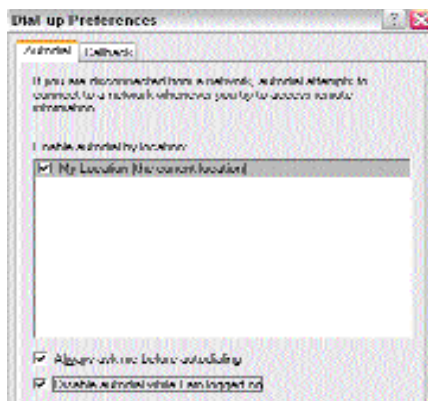
Mystery caller

Q. I use Windows XP. As soon as Windows starts, it begins dialling the Dial-up connection. Even if I close it, it comes up in a few seconds, not allowing me to work. Even if I login to the Internet and sign out, it keeps redialling! Please make this stop.

Pius
Kathmandu

A You can disable automatic dialling entirely. Open **Control Panel > Internet Options > Connections** and set it to 'Never dial a connection'. To connect to the Internet, you can simply double-click the Dial-up connection and manually connect to your ISP before you begin browsing.

If this does not help, open **Control Panel > Network Connections** and click **Advanced > Dial-up Preferences**. From here



Disable automatic dialling in Windows XP

you can disable automatic dialling for the connections.

Deleting unwanted e-mail

Q. I have two e-mail messages that I can't recognise. These may be viruses, which may activate if I click on them, since they would be displayed in the preview pane. I use Outlook Express. How can I delete them without viewing them?

Nabeel Ahmed
Via e-mail

A You can simply turn the preview pane off to not display the message. In Outlook Express, click **View > Layout** and disable the 'Show preview' pane. You will now see only the message list, from where you can delete the messages without viewing them.